

Tuğba Bozçağa

Pron: Ṭūbā | طُوْبَى | توبه

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Academic Positions

2021 -	KING'S COLLEGE LONDON Lecturer in Politics & Political Methodology (Assistant Professor with Tenure)
2024 -	UNIVERSITY OF OXFORD Associate Member, Nuffield College
2024	UNIVERSITY OF OXFORD Visiting Scholar, Department of Politics and IR
2020 - 2022	HARVARD UNIVERSITY Fellow, Harvard Kennedy School Middle East Initiative Postdoctoral Fellow, Harvard Kennedy School Middle East Initiative

Education

2020	MASSACHUSETTS INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY
2019	Maternal leave
	Dissertation: “Essays on the Political Economy of Public Service Provision”
	APSA Mancur Olson Prize for Best Dissertation in Political Economy (Honorable Mention).
2011	CENTRAL EUROPEAN UNIVERSITY
	M.A., International Political Economy (Distinction)
2010	BOGAZICI UNIVERSITY
	B.A., Economics (Dean’s High Honors List)

Affiliations

2021 -	Faculty Fellow, Association for Analytic Learning about Islam and Muslim Societies (AALIMS)
2022 - 2023	Fellow, Governance and Local Development Institute (GLD)
2017 - 2020	Graduate Student Affiliate, Harvard University Center for European Studies

Publications

“The Social Bureaucrat: How Social Proximity Among Bureaucrats Affects Local Governance”. Forthcoming in *American Journal of Political Science*.

- Phi Beta Kappa Award, MPSA; Best Paper by an Emerging Scholar Award, MPSA; Kenneth Meier Best Paper Award in Public Policy and Administration, MPSA; Best

Comparative Policy Paper Award, Public Policy Section, APSA; Honorable Mention for Best Paper Award, MENA Politics Section, APSA.

“Imams and Patrons: Service Provision by Islamist Non-State Actors” (with Fotini Christia). Forthcoming in *Journal of Conflict Resolution*.

- Best Paper Award, MENA Politics Section, APSA; Weber Best Paper Award, Religion and Politics Section, APSA.

“Municipal Government”. *Oxford Bibliographies in Urban Studies*, Oxford University Press, 2025.

“Combining Mobile Data and Satellite Imaging for Human Mobility” (with Asli Cansunar), In *Data Science for Migration and Mobility* (eds. Albert Ali Salah, Emre Eren Korkmaz, and Tuba Bircan), Oxford University Press, 2022.

“The Unintended Consequences of Nation-Making Institutions for Civil Society Development” (with Asli Cansunar). *Journal of Historical Political Economy*, 1(4), 591-613, 2021.

“Assessing Syrian Refugee Integration Using Call Detail Records from Turkey” (with Fotini Christia, Elizabeth Harwood, Constantinos Daskalakis, and Christos Papadimitriou), In *Guide to Mobile Data Analytics in Refugee Scenarios: The ‘Data for Refugees Challenge’ Study* (eds. Albert Ali Salah, Alex Pentland, Bruno Lepri, and Emmanuel Letouzé), Switzerland: Springer, 2019.

“Policy Implications of the D4R Challenge” (with Albert Ali Salah et al.), In *Guide to Mobile Data Analytics in Refugee Scenarios: The ‘Data for Refugees Challenge’ Study* (eds. Albert Ali Salah, Alex Pentland, Bruno Lepri, and Emmanuel Letouzé), Switzerland: Springer, 2019.

“Enforcement Process Tracing: Forbearance and Dilution in Urban Colombia and Turkey” (with Alisha Holland), *Studies in Comparative International Development*, 53(3), 300-323, 2018 (Special Issue).

“Women and the welfare state regime of Turkey”. *Turkish Policy Quarterly*, 11(4), 177-188, Winter 2013.

Working Papers

“Members of the Same Club?: Subnational Variations in Electoral Returns to Public Goods”.

- McGillivray Best Paper Award (Honorable Mention) in Political Economy, APSA.

“Privatization without Regulation: The Political Economy of Electricity Infrastructure and Wildfires”. *Available upon Request*.

“Refugees’ Climate Vulnerability: Evidence from Geocoded Mobility during Seasonal Agricultural Employment”. *Available upon Request*.

“Putting Property Rights in Context: Colonial Cotton Concessions, Customary Land Tenure, and Development in Mozambique” (with Robin Harding and Arinze Nwokolo). *At the final stage before submission to the American Political Science Review*.

“When Incumbent Mayors Affect Representativeness: Incumbency, Education, and Kinship Ties in Municipal Councils” (with Aytug Sasmaz and Rabia Kutlu). *At the final stage before submission to the American Journal of Political Science*.

“The Education Backlash: How Assimilative Primary School Education Affects Insurgency in Areas of Ethnic Conflict” (with Asli Cansunar). WIDER Working Paper 2023/50. Helsinki: UNU-WIDER.

Policy

“The Geography of Gulenism in Turkey” (with Fotini Christia), *Foreign Policy*, March 18, 2019.

“Turkish referendum rallies in Europe made headlines. Did they affect election results?” (with Fotini Christia), *Washington Post*, “The Monkey Cage,” May 6, 2017.

Media Coverage

“Tugba Bozcaga: Social Proximity among Bureaucrats in Turkey,” *Governance Uncovered: Local Politics and Development*, 3 November 2020.

“What makes for better bureaucracy?,” *MIT News*, 21 October 2019.

“Norms, State Capacity, and Elections,” *Rocking our Priors*, 31 August 2019.

Awards, Grants & Fellowships

Performance Recognition Award, KCL, 2024

APSA McGillivray Best Paper Award (Honorable Mention) in Political Economy, 2022.

MPSA Phi Sigma Alpha Award (Best Paper Presented at the Annual Conference), 2022.

MPSA Kenneth J. Meier Award (Best Paper in Bureaucratic Politics, Public Administration, or Public Policy), 2022.

MPSA Best Paper by an Emerging Scholar, 2022.

UNU-WIDER Institutional Legacies of Violent Conflict Research Grant, 2021.

APSA Mancur Olson Prize for Best Dissertation in Political Economy (Honorable Mention), 2021.

APSA Weber Best Paper Award in Religion and Politics, 2021.

APSA MENA Politics Best Paper Award, 2021.

Harvard University Weatherhead Center for International Affairs, Raphael Morrison Dorman Memorial Postdoctoral Fellowship, 2021 - 2022 (Declined).

Harvard Data Science Initiative Postdoctoral Research Fund Award, 2021.

APSA Best Comparative Policy Paper Award, 2020.

APSA MENA Politics Best Paper Award (Honorable Mention), 2020.

APSA First Generation Scholar Travel Grant, 2019.

NSF Society for Political Methodology Annual Meeting Grant, 2019.

MIT Graduate Student Life Grant, 2019. *To organize a kickoff event for first generation college students at MIT's graduate programs.*

Data for Refugees (D4R) Turk Telekom Competition, 2018. *Access to call detail records (CDRs).*

Center of International Studies Summer Grant, MIT, 2016, 2018.

Program on Governance and Local Development Short Term Grant, University of Gothenburg, 2017.

ASMEA Research Grant, 2017 (Declined).

MIT MISTI Mexico Travel Grant, 2014.

MIT Ida M. Green Fellowship, 2013.

Goethe-Institut European Netzwerk Deutsch Fellowship, 2012.

Open Society Foundation Fellowship, Central European University (Tuition and Stipend), 2010.

Bogazici Merit Scholarship, Bogazici University, 2005 - 2010. *Departmental award given to the student ranked 1st in the admission list.*

National Scholarship for Undergraduate Studies, Scientific and Technological Research Council of Turkey (TUBITAK) 2005 - 2010. *Awarded for being in the top hundred (among 1.5m) in the national examination.*

Recent Talks & Presentations

2026 UCL Social Research Institute; Oxford Centre for Islamic Studies; UCL-KCL-LSE-RHUL Politics of the Global South Workshop (discussant, chair); EPSS Annual Meeting; APSA Annual Meeting.

2025 Oxford DPIR Comparative Politics Seminar Series; EPSA Annual Meeting; KCL-UCL-LSE Politics of the Global South Workshop (discussant, chair).

2024 UCL Departmental Research Seminar; APSA (discussant, chair, presenter); KCL-UCL-LSE Politics of the Global South Workshop; EUROWEPS-LSE; AALIMS Annual Meeting-Harvard; Oxford Middle East Centre Seminar Series.

2023 KCL Comparative Politics Seminar Series; APSA Annual Meeting; Annual GLD Conference; HPE HORIZONS 2023 (University of Chicago); MPSA (discussant).

2022 LSE Comparative Politics Seminar Series; Oxford DPIR Seminar Series; Oxford Meeting in Historical Political Economy; APSA Annual Meeting (didn't attend due to visa); KCL-UCL-LSE Politics of the Global South Workshop; Oxford DSPI Seminar Series; AALIMS Conference on the Political Economy of the Muslim World; WIDER Development Conference.

- 2021 Harvard Kennedy School Data Donuts Series; LSE PSPE Seminar; GLD Work-in-Progress Workshop; Kadir Has Economics Seminar Series; APSA Annual Meeting; MESA Annual Meeting; MPSA Annual Meeting (discussant; presenter); Education Politics and Policy Winter Conference.
- 2020 APSA Annual Meeting; APSA Bureaucracy Mini-Conference; MPSA Annual Meeting (panel co-organizer); AALIMS Conference on the Political Economy of the Muslim World; Annual GLD Conference; Society for Institutional and Organizational Economics (SIOE) Annual Meeting; NEWEPS.
- 2019 APSA Annual Meeting; MIT GOV/LAB Political Behavior of Development Conference; POLNET Annual Meeting; PolMeth Annual Meeting.
- 2018 APSA Annual Meeting; AALIMS Conference on the Political Economy of the Muslim World, NYU Abu Dhabi; North East Middle East Politics Working Group (NE-MEPWG), Harvard University.

Meetings Organized

- 2025- KCL-UCL-LSE Politics of the Global South Workshop.
- 2023 POLMETH Europe; Annual GLD Conference.
- 2022 Workshop in the Political Economy of the Middle East and North Africa (PEMENA); EBRD and King's College London Workshop on the Economics and Politics of Migration.

Teaching

KING'S COLLEGE LONDON

- Quantitative Research Methods, 2022 – .
- PE of Development in Muslim Societies, 2023 – .
- Introduction to Comparative Politics (co-taught), 2021 – .
- Research Design, 2021.

MASSACHUSETTS INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY, DEPARTMENT OF POLITICAL SCIENCE

- GitHub Workshop, 2018.
- GIS Visualization and Analysis Workshop, 2018 and 2019.
- L^AT_EX Workshop, MIT, 2016.
- Machine Learning and Data Science in Politics (as Teaching Assistant), 2018.
- Quantitative Research Methods I (as Teaching Assistant), 2016.

MASSACHUSETTS INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY, J-PAL

- J-PAL Executive Education Course, 2016.

BOGAZICI UNIVERSITY, DEPARTMENT OF ECONOMICS

- Intermediate Macroeconomics (as Teaching Assistant), 2008 and 2009.
- Principles of Macroeconomics (as Teaching Assistant), 2008.

Professional Service

REVIEWER:

American Economic Review, American Political Science Review, American Journal of Political Science, British Journal of Political Science, Comparative Political Studies, Journal of Demographic Economics, Journal of Comparative Economics, Journal of Political Institutions and Political Economy, Middle East Law and Governance, European Political Science Review, European Journal of Politics and Gender.

INSTITUTIONAL:

Admissions Chair, Departmental Postgraduate Committee, KCL, 2021 - Present.

Departmental Research Committee, KCL, 2022 - Present.

School of Politics and Economics Space Allocation Committee, KCL, 2024 - Present.

Inaugural First-Generation Constituency Representative, MIT GSC, 2019 - 2020.

Organizer, Kickoff Event for First-Gen Students at MIT's Graduate Programs, 2019.

Member, Committee on Race and Diversity, MIT, 2016 - 2017.

DISCIPLINARY:

Council Member of the APSA Political Economy Section, 2024 - .

Member of the APSA Committee on First Generation Scholars in the Profession, 2024 - .

Award Committee Member, APSA MENA Politics Section, Best Paper Award, 2024.

Award Committee Member, APSA Politics and Religion Section, Weber Best Paper Award, 2022.

Other

Research Transparency and Reproducibility Training (RT2), BITSS/CEGA, 2018.

Kaufman Teaching Certificate Program, 2018.

The Institute for Qualitative and Multi-Method Research, 2016.

Work Experience

Project Manager, Ministry of Foreign Affairs Directorate for EU Affairs, Turkey, 2011 - 2013.

Designed, implemented, and evaluated capacity building projects on local governments and civil society organizations; coordinated a research project consortium with a budget of 2,500,000 Euros submitted to the European Union (Ranked 2nd among 15 consortiums).

Skills

LANGUAGES:

Turkish (native), German (advanced), Spanish (working proficiency), Ottoman Turkish (limited working proficiency), Arabic (limited working proficiency).

SOFTWARE:

ArcGIS, Atlas-ti, iGraph, L^AT_EX, Python, R, Qualtrics.

Last updated April 2026